

CV Review vs the CSG Seat

Full feedback on the Janak Chohan CV, ranked against Asset Management, Client Solutions Group — London Summer Analyst (req 171037)

Reviewed to Sam's rules + the Goldman screen + the CSG keyword map · priorities:

P0 fix before submitting

P1 strategic

P2 polish

STRONG keep

Verdict

8.3_{/10} for THIS role, after the P0 fixes below. Top-decile among realistic applicants to this seat.

This CV's profile-to-role fit is unusually good: **client servicing and onboarding at an asset manager is literally the feeder experience for Client Solutions Group**, a placement year in client operations proves stamina and systems fluency, and the stock-pitch work shows investment literacy. The honest drag is university prestige — and it is offset by the single strongest line on the page, which, remarkably, your cover letter never mentions:

You did a Goldman Sachs Spring Week. In FICC & Equities. That changes your letter, and it may change your outcome.

1. The headline finding: your Goldman Spring Week is being wasted P1

Sam's own lecture, verbatim: spring weeks are *"the most predictive factor on your CV, more than other internships"* — and a GS spring week on a GS application is the strongest possible connection signal: you are a **returning candidate the firm has already selected once**. Two implications:

- **The letter should acknowledge it.** Your current draft opens on the LSE conference and Ahmed — good — but a reader will see "Goldman Sachs Spring Intern" on the CV and wonder why the letter is silent about your actual time inside the building. Better: it hands you Sam's exact Optiver engine, with Goldman itself as chapter one: *the spring week in FICC & Equities showed you the markets floor and the client relationships on it (Jack's world); what you then found at Pictet was that the client lifecycle in asset management — longer, deeper, mandate-based — is where you want to build; CSG is the synthesis*. "I liked X, I found Y, this seat combines them" — with both chapters at real firms, one of them Goldman. Almost no CSG applicant can write that paragraph.
- **It reframes "why the internship" too:** the spring week → summer analyst path is the firm's own pipeline; you're completing a journey it started.

2. Section-by-section feedback

Header STRONG with one check

- Clean: name, email, phone, LinkedIn. Ensure the LinkedIn link is **black, not hyperlink blue** (Sam's print rule), and consider lowercase for the email.

Education — two decisions and one typo

- STRONG **"Average Grade: 81% (First Class)"** — exactly Sam's format, and 81% is genuinely excellent. Graduation date is prominent. Keep.
- P1 — the ordering decision. Sam's rule: education first *unless* you're at a serious non-target where the university delays your best material. UEA is a non-target for GS London front office — and your experience section (Pictet + placement + **a GS spring week**) is your strongest asset. There is a real case for **Work Experience first** on this CV. Counterweight: the 81% First is a genuine credential and screeners expect education on top. My call: **experience**

first for this application, education immediately after with the 81% bolded — but this is a judgement call, not a rule; either is defensible.

- **P0 typo:** "(selected from 250 students)" has stray spaces inside the brackets — Sam's zero-typo rule. Also "selected from 250 students" → consider "of 250" for tightness.
- **P2:** A-levels Economics (A), Maths (B), Physics (C). Sam's guidance: include unless truly poor — ABC stays in (omitting invites worse assumptions). School date range "Sep 2016 – Jun 2023" is fine.
- **P1 eligibility note — get this exactly right on the knockout questions:** graduating **Jun 2027** makes you a **final-year** applicant for summer 2027 — eligible under the posting's "penultimate or final year of study," and for finalists the internship is effectively the full-time pipeline. Answer the portal's graduation-date question with total precision (that field is the one true auto-reject), and be ready for "why a summer internship in your final year?" — answer: it is how GS London hires; spring → summer → full-time is the firm's own path.

Pictet — your engine room **STRONG**, three mechanical fixes

- **P0:** Bullet 1: "questionnaires, DDQs," → **"questionnaires (DDQs)"** — the parenthetical is both correct punctuation and the searchable abbreviation. Also hyphenate **"400-line Excel tracker"** and **"auto-assigning."**
- **P0:** Bullet 3 lost its number — restore **"Progressed 50 segregated market openings"**. It was your best quantification and Sam's first commandment is quantify. Also hyphenate **"trade-ready."**
- **Keep:** the keyword work is now done well — institutional clients, DDQs, client mandate onboarding, relationship managers, custodians, client service, performance reporting: the CSG map is covered without stuffing.
- **P1 consistency:** your letter draft says "Pictet's Global Client Group" / "client onboarding team"; the CV says "Client Servicing and Onboarding Summer Analyst." Make the letter use the CV's naming (or the real team name) — GS cross-references the two documents, and the letter's "coordinating compliance, relationship managers and operations" should also echo bullet 3's cast (custodians, relationship managers). Align once, everywhere.

Box placement year **SOLID**, one clarity fix

- Good breadth: quota modelling with a real figure (\$3.8m), onboarding again, Salesforce named (your best skills keyword corroborated in a bullet — exactly how it should work).
- **P2:** Bullet 2 reads ambiguously — "Built joint onboarding plan sequencing tasks... by day 60" → clearer as **"Built a 60-day joint onboarding plan sequencing tasks across consulting, support and account teams."**
- **P2:** Bullet 4 is a task without an outcome — if the consolidated account view was *used* for something (renewals, QBRs, handovers), say so in three words.

Goldman Sachs Spring Week **YOUR CROWN JEWEL**

- Both bullets are honest ("simulated"), specific and quantified — \$20m book, eleven trades, realised vs unrealised P&L, thesis discipline. Exactly how to write a spring week per Sam's template. No changes to the bullets.
- Reverse chronology correctly places it third — fine. Its power is activated in the *letter* (see §1), not by moving it.

Oakwood Fund — the URBN pitch **GENUINELY IMPRESSIVE**

- The Nuuly thesis (market applying apparel-retail multiples to a group compounding a rental sub at ~60%) and the *reasoned rejection of the DCF* (terminal value dominating the output) are the most intellectually distinctive lines on the page — this is Sam's "demonstrate knowledge implicitly" done perfectly. An interviewer will go here: **re-load the numbers before any interview** (current URBN price vs your \$75 fair value, what happened since).
- **P2:** title reads oddly — "Equity Research President, Retail Sector." If accurate, consider **"President & Retail Sector Head, Equity Research"** or the fund's real titling. Also state what Oakwood is in-line if space allows ("student-managed fund") — a screener may not know.

Skills & Interests

- **Technical line is right for CSG:** Excel (Power Query, pivot tables), Salesforce, Bloomberg, PowerPoint — consider "Salesforce (CRM)". Add **languages** if you have two or more; add **eVestment** only if you truly touched it at Pictet.

- **P1 — the sandwiches problem:** "sandwiches" is *Sam's own lecture example*, told to your whole cohort — other Tracker students may have it too, and an interviewer's follow-up needs a genuine five-minute story. If it's truly yours, keep it and prepare the spiel; if borrowed, cut it — boarding pass collecting, spice blending and The Karate Kid (1984) are already a superb esoteric line on their own.

3. The scorecard vs req 171037

Dimension	Score	Reasoning
Division alignment (does the history point at CSG?)	9/10	Client servicing + onboarding at an asset manager is the closest feeder experience that exists for this seat. The five-second read answers "why this desk" by itself.
Firm connection	9/10	GS spring week (selected once already) + insight events + LSE AIC. Top tier — currently under-used in the letter.
Client-facing evidence	8.5/10	Pictet queries/onboarding/reporting + Box client operations. Would be 9+ with the restored "50" and an outcome on Box b4.
Markets & investment literacy	7.5/10	Spring week book + URBN pitch + Bloomberg. Strong for a client seat; not an investing-seat CV — which is fine, you're not applying to one.
Academics	6.5/10	81% First is excellent; UEA non-target and ABC A-levels are the drag. The spring week is the great equaliser here — the firm has already judged you once and said yes.
Keywords & searchability (Oracle parse + recruiter search)	8.5/10	Tier-1 and Tier-2 CSG terms present and truthful; Salesforce corroborated in a bullet. Parse-safe if the layout stays single-column.
Mechanics (typos, hyphens, consistency)	7/10 → 9.5	Four P0 items (bracket spaces, DDQs punctuation, missing 50, hyphens). Trivial to fix; fatal to leave, by Sam's zero-typo rule.
Overall, for this seat	8.3/10	Top-decile fit. The gap between this CV and an offer is not the CV — it's execution: the letter using the spring week, precise knockout answers, and interview conversion.

4. The fix list, in order

1. **P0** Restore **"50"** segregated market openings; fix "(DDQs)"; fix bracket spacing in Head Boy line; hyphenate 400-line, auto-assigning, trade-ready. Then re-run the zero-typo pass and the PDF select-and-copy test.
2. **P1** Decide **experience-first vs education-first** (my call: experience first for this application, given non-target + this experience set).
3. **P1** **Rework the letter's arc to include the spring week** — chapter one of the like/lack engine, Goldman itself as the first chapter.
4. **P1** Align letter ↔ CV naming (team name, coordination cast) and settle the sandwiches question.
5. **P2** Box bullet 2 rephrase ("60-day plan"), Box bullet 4 outcome, Oakwood title/descriptor, "Salesforce (CRM)", languages line if applicable.
6. Before any interview: **re-load URBN** (price vs your \$75 target, what's happened since) and the spring-week trades — Sam's own Goldman final-round story is the cautionary tale: they grill two-year-old bullets.

Bottom line: this is a genuinely strong CV for exactly this seat — rare profile-to-role fit, a Goldman stamp already on it, and real quantified substance. Fix the four mechanical items, put the spring week to work in the letter, answer the eligibility questions with total precision, and submit with confidence. The CV is no longer the risk; execution is.

Method. Reviewed against: Sam Leong's CV rules from your course transcripts (one page, quantification, one task per bullet, objective language, zero typos, interest-line strategy, education-ordering exception for non-targets, spring-week weighting); the Goldman/Oracle screen mechanics (parse safety, recruiter search terms, knockout eligibility questions) from docs 10–12; and the CSG keyword map from doc 13. Scores are calibrated judgement against a realistic applicant pool for this specific requisition, not a guarantee — the screen is human and rolling. Verify the Oakwood titling and any added skills before use.